



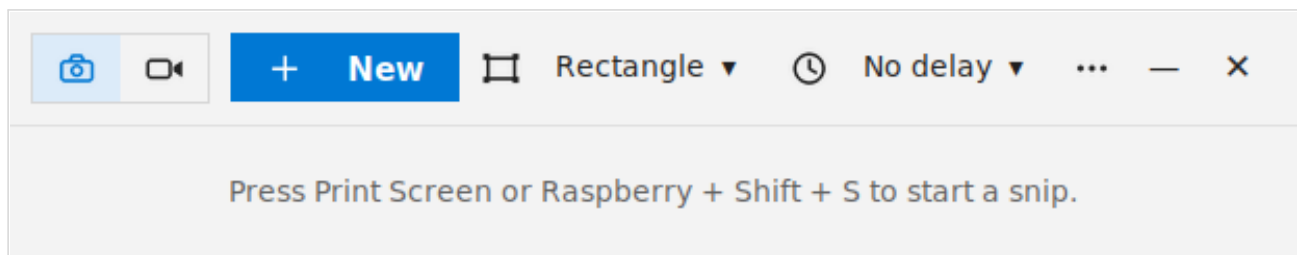
PiSnip

Snipping Tool for Raspberry Pi 400

User Manual · Version 1.0 · September 2026

Take, mark up and share screenshots — the Windows way, on your Pi

PiSnip brings the look and feel of the Windows 11 Snipping Tool to your Raspberry Pi 400. Press a key, drag around what you want, and the picture is saved to **Pictures/Screenshots** and copied to the clipboard, ready to paste.



The PiSnip main window

What PiSnip can do

- Snip a rectangle, a window, a freeform shape or the full screen, with an optional 3, 5 or 10 second delay.
- Save every snip automatically to Pictures/Screenshots and copy it to the clipboard.
- Show a preview pop-up after each snip, just like Windows.
- Mark up snips with a pen, highlighter, shapes, arrows and text, then crop, copy, save or print them.
- Read the text in a snip, and black out email addresses and phone numbers before sharing.
- Record a video of your screen.

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How to read this manual Words in **bold** are buttons or menu items you can click. Keys to press look like this: **Ctrl + N**.

1. Installing PiSnip

You only need to do this once. It takes a few minutes, mostly while the Pi downloads the helper programs PiSnip uses.

1. Copy **PiSnip.zip** to your Pi 400 (a USB stick is the easiest way) and put it somewhere handy, such as your Home folder.
2. Right-click the zip file and choose **Extract Here**. You get a folder called **pisnip**.
3. Open the **pisnip** folder, then press **F4** (or choose **Tools → Open Current Folder in Terminal**) to open a Terminal there.
4. Type **bash install.sh** and press **Enter**. Enter your password if the Pi asks for it.
5. Wait for the message **Done!**. If a keyboard shortcut doesn't respond straight away, log out and back in once.

What the installer sets up

- A **Snipping Tool** icon on your **desktop** and on the **taskbar**, plus an entry in the menu under **Accessories**.
- Keyboard shortcuts: **Print Screen** and **Raspberry + Shift + S** to snip, **Raspberry + Shift + R** to record.
- The **Pictures/Screenshots** folder, where every snip is saved automatically.
- The helper programs PiSnip needs: screen capture, clipboard, text reading (Tesseract) and video recording.

Tip Updating to a newer PiSnip? Just unzip the new version and run **bash install.sh** again. Your settings and screenshots are kept.

Good to know The Raspberry key is the key with the raspberry logo, next to the left Alt key. It does the same job as the Windows key on a PC.

2. Quick start

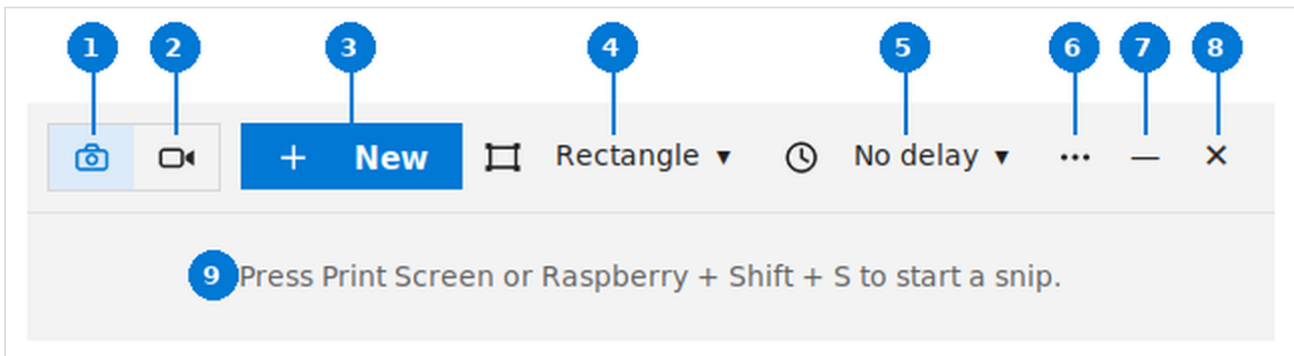
There are three ways to take a snip:

Do this	What happens
Press Print Screen	The screen freezes and dims. Drag around what you want. A preview pops up in the corner.
Press Raspberry + Shift + S	Exactly the same as Print Screen (like Win + Shift + S on Windows).
Click the Snipping Tool icon , then + New	The screen freezes. After you snip, the picture opens in the editor so you can draw on it.

Every snip is **saved** to Pictures/Screenshots and **copied** to the clipboard straight away, so you can paste it into an email, chat or document with **Ctrl + V**.

3. The main window

Click the **Snipping Tool** icon on the desktop or taskbar to open the main window. It is small on purpose, like the Windows version.

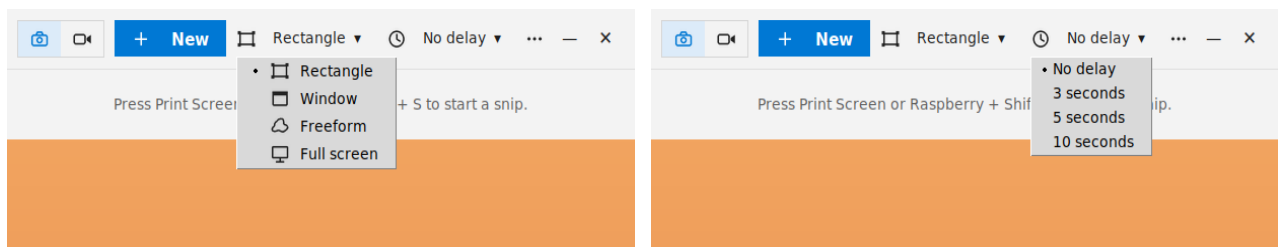


The controls of the main window

#	Control	What it does
1	Snip (camera)	Switches to taking pictures (screenshots). Highlighted in blue when selected.
2	Record (video camera)	Switches to recording video of your screen. See section 8.
3	+ New	Starts a new snip or recording. Shortcut: Ctrl + N .
4	Snipping mode	Choose Rectangle, Window, Freeform or Full screen. See section 4.
5	Time delay	No delay, 3, 5 or 10 seconds. Gives you time to open a menu before the snip.

#	Control	What it does
6	⋮ (See more)	Settings, Open file, the Screenshots and Recordings folders, add desktop and taskbar icons, set up keyboard shortcuts, About.
7	— Minimise	Tucks the window away on the taskbar.
8	× Close	Closes the window (Ctrl + W also works). Your keyboard shortcuts keep working.
9	Hint	Reminds you which key starts a snip or a recording.

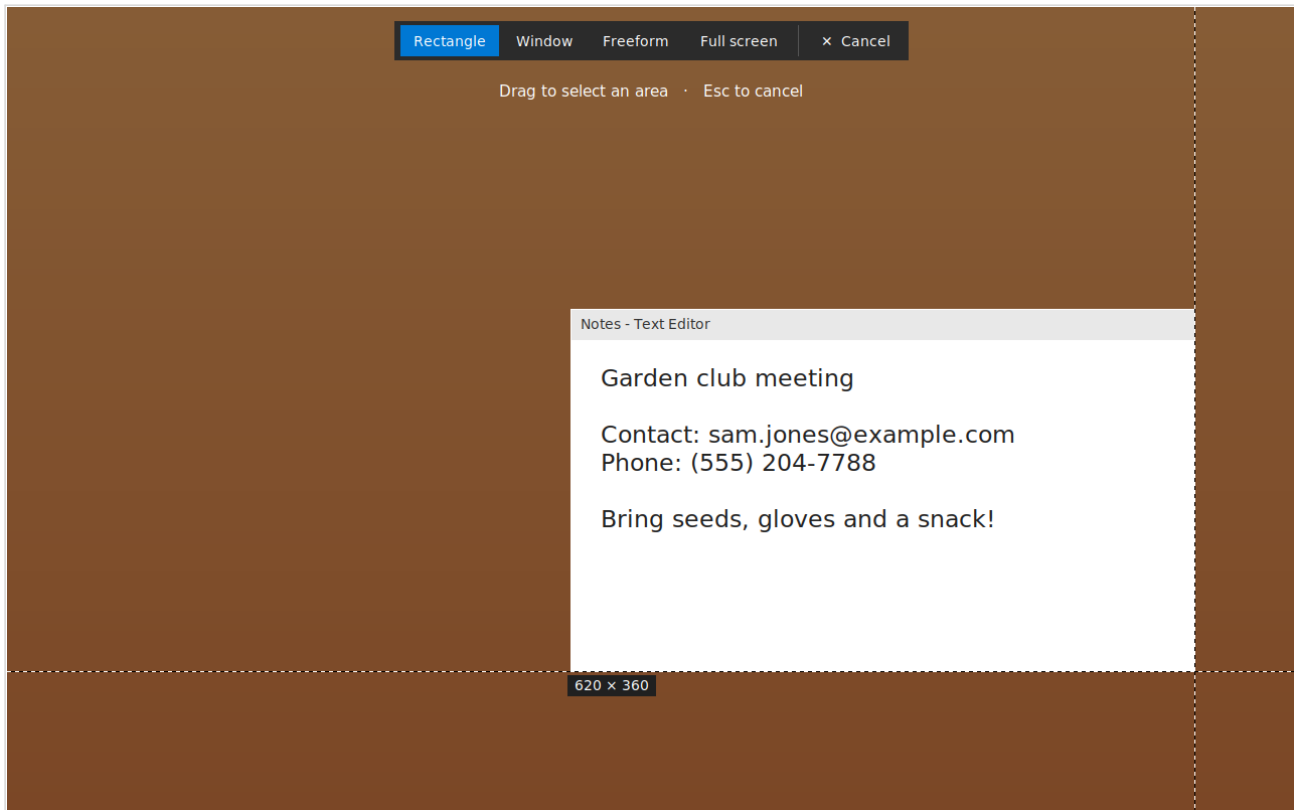
The mode and delay you pick are remembered, and they also apply when you use the keyboard shortcuts.



The snipping-mode menu (left) and the time-delay menu (right)

4. Taking a snip

When you start a snip, PiSnip freezes the screen and dims it. The mouse pointer turns into a **crosshair**, with faint dashed guide lines across the screen, so you know it's ready. Whatever you drag over is shown bright, with its size in pixels underneath.



Snipping a rectangle: the chosen area is bright, the rest is dimmed, and the crosshair guides follow the mouse

Snipping modes

Mode	How to use it
Rectangle	Press and hold the mouse button, drag a box around what you want, then let go.
Window	Move the mouse over a window (it lights up) and click to snip that whole window. See the note below.
Freeform	Hold the mouse button and draw any shape around what you want. Everything outside the shape is left out.
Full screen	Captures the whole screen at once.

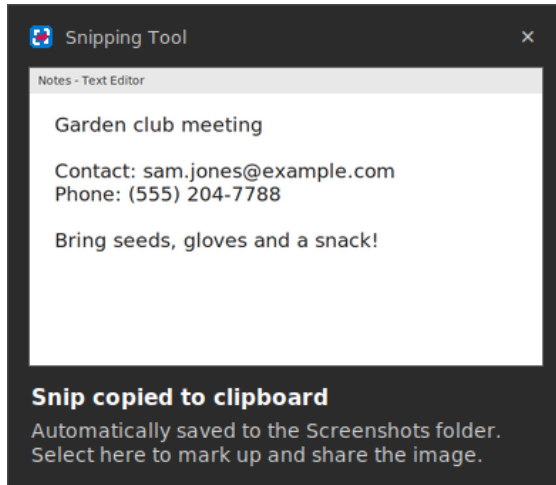
You can switch modes with the bar at the top of the frozen screen. To cancel, press **Esc**, right-click, or click **x Cancel**.

Note Window mode needs the X11 desktop. On the Pi's standard Wayland desktop, apps can't tell where other windows are, so PiSnip asks you to drag around the window instead. To use click-a-window snips, open a Terminal, run **sudo raspi-config**, choose **Advanced Options → Wayland → X11**, then reboot.

Using a time delay

Choose 3, 5 or 10 seconds in the delay menu, then click **+ New**. A countdown appears in the middle of the screen. Use the time to open the menu or tooltip you want to capture. When the countdown ends, the screen freezes as usual.

5. The preview pop-up



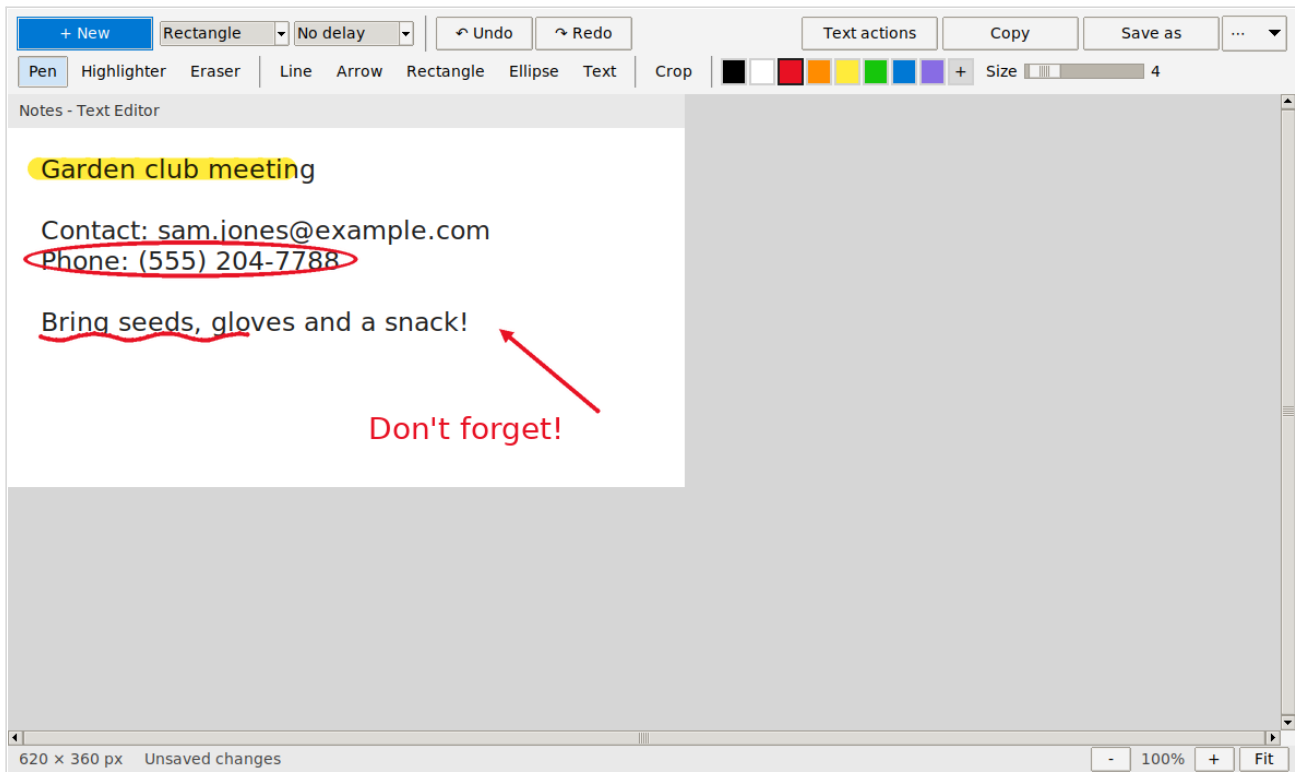
After a snip taken with **Print Screen** or **Raspberry + Shift + S**, a preview slides in at the bottom-right corner of the screen, just like on Windows.

- It shows the picture you just took.
- It confirms the snip was copied to the clipboard and saved.
- **Click the preview** to open the snip in the editor and draw on it.
- Click **X** to dismiss it, or just wait. It goes away by itself after about 8 seconds (it stays while the mouse is over it).

Snips started with the **+ New** button skip the preview and open straight in the editor. If you'd like shortcut snips to do the same, turn on **Open the editor straight away after a keyboard-shortcut snip** in Settings.

6. Marking up a snip (the editor)

The editor lets you draw on your snip, add text, crop it and save it. Your original snip is already saved, so nothing is lost if you make a mistake.



The editor with a highlighter, a circle, a pen underline, an arrow and some text

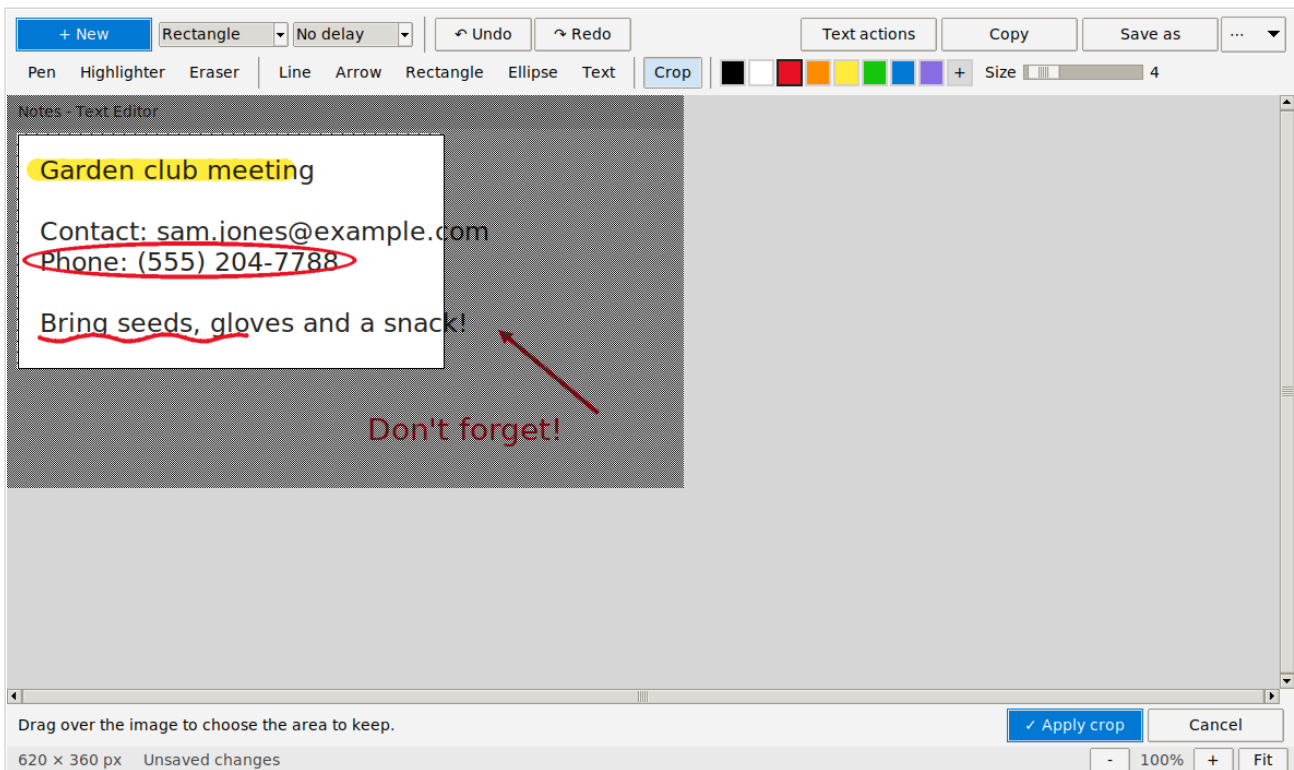
Top toolbar

Button	What it does
+ New, mode, delay	Take another snip without going back to the main window.
Undo / Redo	Step backwards or forwards through your changes (Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Y).
Text actions	Read the text in the picture so you can copy it, or black out details. See section 7.
Copy	Copies the marked-up picture to the clipboard (Ctrl + C).
Save as	Saves the picture where you choose, as PNG, JPG or GIF (Ctrl + S).
... menu	Open file, open the Screenshots folder, Print, Erase all ink, Revert to original, Record screen, Settings.

Drawing tools

Tool	How to use it
Pen	Draw freely with the mouse.
Highlighter	A see-through marker. Text underneath stays readable.
Eraser	Click or drag over a drawing to remove the whole stroke, as on Windows.
Line / Arrow	Drag from the start point to the end point. Arrows point to where you let go.
Rectangle / Ellipse	Drag to draw a box or a circle around something.
Text	Click where the text should go, type, then press Enter . Esc cancels.
Crop	Drag over the part you want to keep, then click Apply crop (or press Enter).

Pick a **colour** from the row of swatches, or click **+** for any colour. The **Size** slider sets the thickness (or the text size when the Text tool is selected). The pen and the highlighter each remember their own colour and size.



Cropping: the area outside the box is shaded and will be removed when you click Apply crop

Zoom

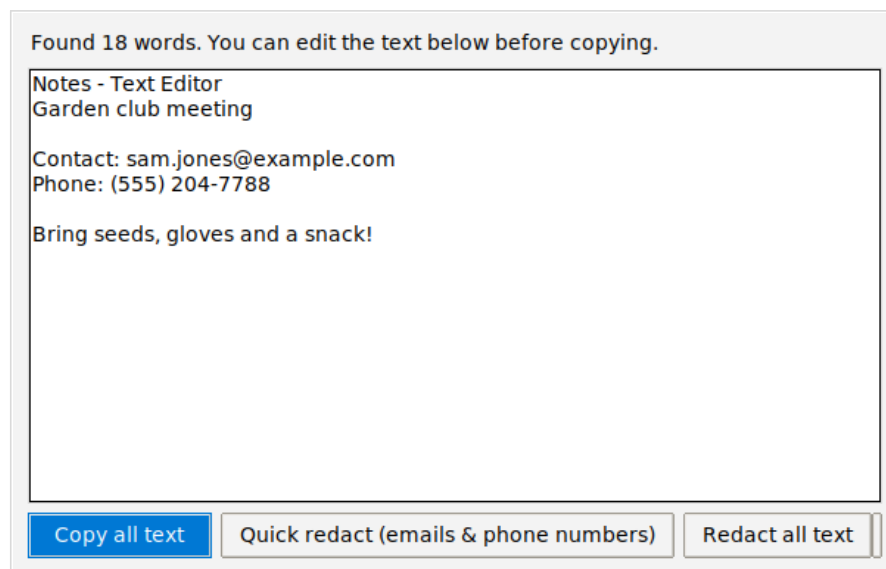
The zoom controls are at the bottom-right of the editor: **–** and **+** zoom out and in, **Fit** fits the whole snip in the window, and clicking the percentage returns to 100%. You can also hold **Ctrl** and turn the mouse wheel.

Closing the editor

If you've made changes that aren't saved, PiSnip asks whether to save them. Choose **Yes** to save, **No** to throw the changes away (the original snip stays in Pictures/Screenshots), or **Cancel** to keep editing.

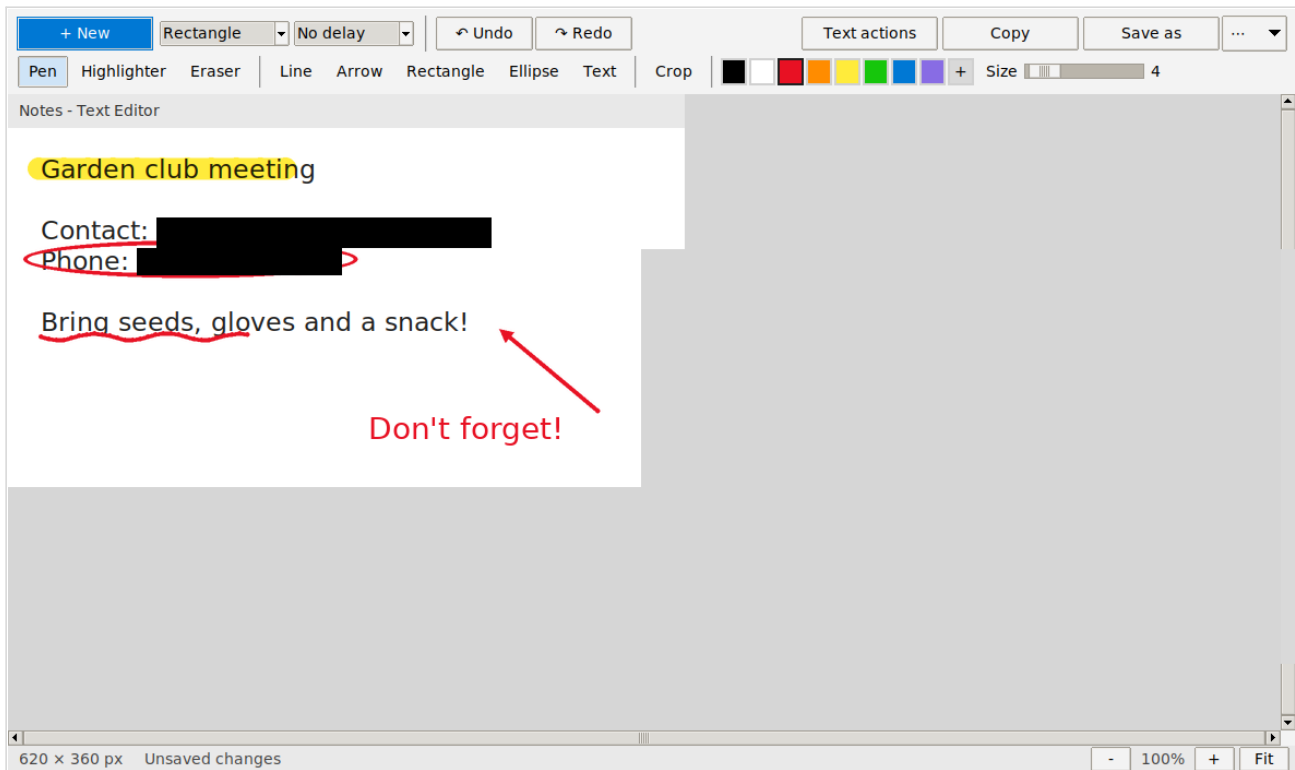
7. Text actions: copy text and hide details

Text actions reads the words in your snip, much like the Windows feature of the same name. Click **Text actions** in the editor and wait a few seconds while the Pi reads the picture.



The Text actions window, showing the text found in the snip

- **Copy all text:** copies the words so you can paste them into a document. You can correct any mistakes in the box first.
- **Quick redact:** covers every email address and phone number with a black box, handy before sharing a snip.
- **Redact all text:** blacks out all the words in the picture.

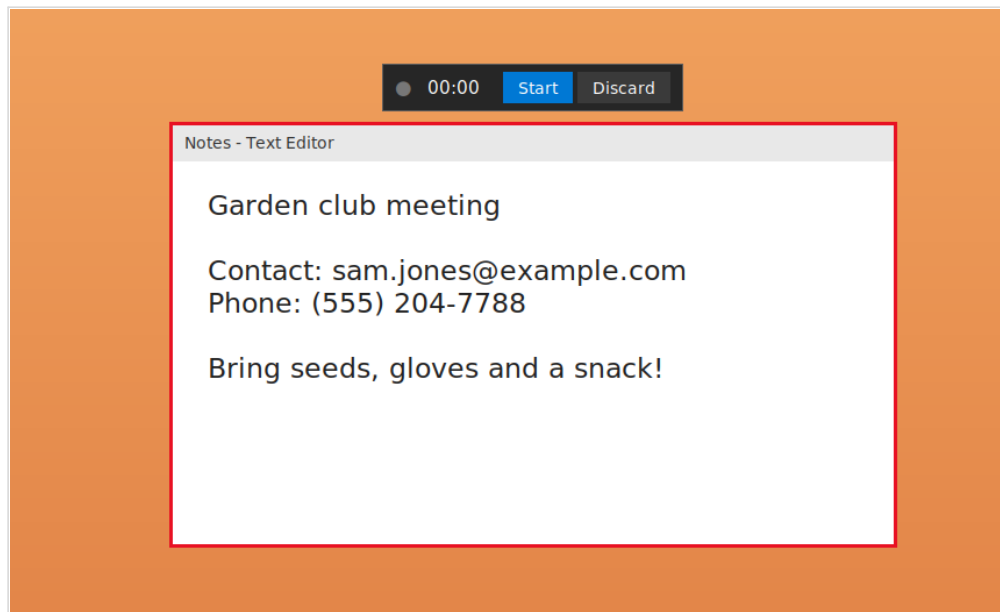


After Quick redact: the email address and phone number are covered

Tip Redactions work like any other drawing, so **Undo** removes them if you change your mind. Make sure you save or copy the picture after redacting. The original, un-redacted snip is still in your Screenshots folder, so delete it if it holds private details.

8. Recording your screen

1. Click the **video camera** in the main window and then **+ New**, or press **Raspberry + Shift + R**.
2. Drag around the area you want to record, or click **Full screen** in the bar at the top.
3. A red frame marks the area and a small control bar appears. Click **Start**. Recording begins after a 3-2-1 countdown.
4. Click **Stop** when you're done. A message tells you the video was saved, with buttons to **Play** it or open its folder.
5. Click **Discard** at any time to throw the recording away.



Ready to record: the red frame shows the area, and the control bar has Start and Discard

Recordings are saved as **.mp4** videos in **Videos/Screen Recordings**, named with the date and time.

Note Recordings don't include sound. Recording a large area at full speed is hard work for a Pi 400. If a video is jerky, record a smaller area.

9. Settings

Open Settings from the **⋮** menu in the main window or the editor. Click **Save** to keep your changes.

Snipping

Save screenshots to Browse...

☒ Automatically save screenshots

☒ Automatically copy changes to the clipboard

Auto-save format

☒ Ask to save edited screenshots when closing

☐ Open the editor straight away after a keyboard-shortcut snip (instead of the preview pop-up)

☐ Multiple windows (each new snip opens in its own window)

☒ Show crosshair guide lines while snipping

☐ Add border to each screenshot

Colour Thickness

Screen recording

Save recordings to Browse...

Frame rate (X11)

Keyboard shortcuts

Print Screen or Raspberry+Shift+S = snip, Raspberry+Shift+R = record Set up shortcuts

Snipping Tool icon on the desktop and taskbar Add icons

System check

Session: X11 (labwc)

xclip ✓ tesseract ✓ ffmpeg ✓ xwininfo ✓

Save

Cancel

The Settings window

Setting	What it means
Save screenshots to	The folder for automatic saves. Normally Pictures/Screenshots.
Automatically save screenshots	Save every snip the moment you take it. Turn off to save only when you choose Save as.
Automatically copy to the clipboard	Put every snip on the clipboard, ready to paste.
Auto-save format	PNG (sharpest, the default) or JPG (smaller files).
Ask to save edited screenshots	Ask before closing the editor with unsaved drawings.
Open the editor straight away...	Keyboard-shortcut snips open in the editor instead of showing the preview pop-up.
Multiple windows	Each new snip opens in its own editor window instead of replacing the current one.
Show crosshair guide lines	Show the dashed lines that follow the pointer while snipping.

Setting	What it means
Add border to each screenshot	Draw a thin border around every snip. Choose its colour and thickness.
Save recordings to / Frame rate	Where videos go, and how smooth they are (the frame rate is used on the X11 desktop).
Set up shortcuts / Add icons	Put the keyboard shortcuts or the desktop and taskbar icons back if they go missing.
System check	Shows whether the helper programs are installed (✓) or missing (✗).

10. Keyboard shortcuts

Anywhere on the Pi

Keys	Action
Print Screen	New snip
Raspberry + Shift + S	New snip
Raspberry + Shift + R	Record the screen

While snipping

Keys / mouse	Action
Esc or right-click	Cancel the snip
Drag with the left button	Choose the area

In the main window and editor

Keys	Action
Ctrl + N	New snip
Ctrl + S	Save as
Ctrl + C	Copy the picture
Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Y	Undo / Redo
Ctrl + O	Open an image file
Ctrl + P	Print
Ctrl + + / Ctrl + - / Ctrl + 0	Zoom in / out / back to 100%
Enter	Apply a crop, or finish typing text
Esc	Cancel a crop or text
Ctrl + W	Close the window

11. Where your files go

What	Where
Screenshots	Pictures/Screenshots , named like <i>Screenshot 2026-09-27 124512.png</i> (date, then time)
Screen recordings	Videos/Screen Recordings , named like <i>Screen Recording 2026-09-27 124512.mp4</i>
Settings	A hidden folder in your Home folder: <code>.config/pisnip</code>
The app itself	A hidden folder in your Home folder: <code>.local/share/pisnip</code>

To find your snips, open the File Manager and go to **Pictures → Screenshots**, or choose **Open Screenshots folder** from the `⋮` menu.

12. Troubleshooting

Print Screen or Raspberry + Shift + S does nothing.

Log out and back in (or restart the Pi) so the desktop picks up the new shortcuts. If they still don't work, open Settings and click **Set up shortcuts**, then log out and in again.

The Snipping Tool icon isn't on the taskbar.

Log out and back in. If it's still missing, add it by hand: right-click an empty part of the top taskbar, choose **Add / Remove Plugins...** (or **Panel Settings**), select the **Launcher** plugin and click **Configure** (or **Preferences**), then find *Snipping Tool* under **Accessories** and add it. Running **bash install.sh** again, or clicking **Add icons** in Settings, also tries again.

The main window has no title bar.

Use the × and — buttons at the top-right of the PiSnip window itself, or press Ctrl + W to close it.

Window mode asks me to drag instead of clicking a window.

That is normal on the Wayland desktop. See the note in section 4 for how to switch to X11 if you want click-a-window snips.

Paste doesn't work after a snip.

Check that **Automatically copy to the clipboard** is on in Settings, and look at **System check**: wl-copy (Wayland) or xclip (X11) should show ✓. Run **bash install.sh** again to reinstall anything missing.

Text actions says Tesseract is missing, or finds no text.

Run **bash install.sh** again. Text reading works best on clear, normal-sized text. Very small or fancy fonts may not be recognised.

Recording says a program is missing, or stops straight away.

Run **bash install.sh** again to install wf-recorder (Wayland) or ffmpeg (X11). Try a smaller recording area.

Double-clicking the desktop icon asks "Execute?".

Choose **Execute**. The installer normally turns this question off. To stop it yourself, open the File Manager, choose **Edit → Preferences → General** and tick *Don't ask options on launch executable file*.

13. Removing PiSnip

Open a Terminal in the **pisnip** folder and type **bash uninstall.sh**. This removes the app, its icons and its keyboard shortcuts, and restores the desktop settings the installer changed. Your screenshots and recordings are **not** deleted.